Responsible AI use in the holiday camp

This policy applies to both tracks. The programme teaches students to write, read, test and explain Python and basic data work themselves. AI assistants are a late-programme literacy topic, not a substitute for learning or a required development tool. No learner account or paid AI subscription is required.

Weeks 1–6

AI-generated solutions are not permitted for core exercises, labs or assessments. This includes asking an assistant to produce, complete, rewrite or debug an answer for submission, using generated notebook/report text, and accepting generative code-completion suggestions. Disable generative suggestions in editors during these activities. Ordinary syntax highlighting and non-generative completion of existing names are fine.

Students may use the supplied worked examples, official documentation and instructor explanations. The independent variation must be their own work. If stuck, save the error, describe what they tried and ask the instructor. AI assistance is not a prerequisite for participation.

Weeks 7–8

AI assistants are introduced through demonstration, critique and limited supervised use after students can write, read, test and explain basic code. Core exercises remain free of AI-generated solutions. The tutor checks readiness individually: explain a variable and a loop, trace a small function, predict its result and test an edge case. Provide a repair exercise before assisted work if any step is unclear.

Permitted supervised uses are asking for an explanation of an error, requesting a hint or possible test cases, and evaluating a proposed change to code the learner has already written. Students make an independent attempt first. Do not ask for an entire project, assessment answer, report or replacement solution. Use only supplied synthetic examples; do not paste personal information, classmates' work or account credentials.

For every permitted interaction, keep AI_USE_LOG.md with: date and tool (or teacher-written demonstration); the original attempt; exact question and relevant reply; advice accepted or rejected and why; tests performed and results. If no AI assistance was used, record "No AI assistance used." This record is evidence of checking, not a reward for using AI.

A plausible answer is not a verified answer. Read the proposed code, predict what it does, test it against known results and explain the change. Preserve the unaided attempt. Learners remain responsible for understanding, testing and explaining every part of submitted work. AI-generated explanations cannot stand in for their own account of the reasoning.

Final assessment

Students must demonstrate and explain their work without AI assistance. Close assistant windows and disable generative suggestions. They may open their saved project and course-approved references, but the explanation, response to questions and a small instructor-chosen code variation must be unaided. A saved AI log is disclosure, not permission to consult an assistant during assessment.

Assess the published technical criteria and individual understanding. Do not infer misconduct from writing style or an AI-detector score. If the evidence is unclear, ask the learner to explain and reproduce a small relevant part. Document the specific gap and use the published repair opportunity. Apply agreed accessibility accommodations without having an AI assistant supply the assessed reasoning.

Instructor implementation

Introduce the policy in Session 1 and revisit it before each checkpoint. Session 19 repeats the project disclosure rules. Session 21 includes the supervised coding-assistant critique in AI_CODING_ASSISTANTS_LAB.pdf, within the existing class. Session 23 may connect these skills to modern AI using MODERN_AI_ORIENTATION.pdf. Session 24 uses an unaided demonstration. These activities add no classes, fees, assessment weight or required commercial product.

Explain to parents: the first six weeks build independent foundations; the final weeks show where assistance may help and how to challenge it. The certificate reflects demonstrated skills, not the ability to obtain generated answers.